

soon began to procure bauxite from southeastern Europe, especially Hungary; and Farben was at work to eliminate the import altogether, by making aluminum from German clay. By the end of 1937 German aluminum production was the largest in the world. It had increased since the Nazis came to power from 20,000 metric tons a year to 120,000 metric tons. Before the war, production was to be increased again, to unimaginable figures.

1937 - - a year of such amazing German industrialization that its direction was obscured by the magic words of enterprise; "production miracles," "greatest technological advances since Ford," 1938 - - an amazing productivity that explained itself to many a technical American mind, without Nazi explanations; for such was the efficacy of large-scale production that volume alone, apparently unharnessed to the sudden, unbelievable event we call war, is a virtue. "Imports" and "exports" are economics, carrying no guns. Synthetic gasoline had been a peacetime dream since the Model-T Ford, even in the United States of America which, along with two League of Nations Members, controlled nearly all the petroleum in the world. By rationing that one raw material, England, France and the United States had held the power to stop the war in Abyssinia in a matter of hours. But "imports and exports" were merely business then; and even though Germany had few large trade-uses for petroleum, when she began to reduce her exports of petroleum, we acclaimed again the miracle of industrial substitutes. Germany could not get enough naptha from the United States, Russia, Venezuela, Persia, the Dutch Indies and Rumania. Besides, the naptha supply for the whole world would last on ly 20 to 30 years. But with Farben's new process - - hydrogenation of coal - - Germany could make all the naptha she wanted - - and Germany's coal, Farben estimated, would last a thousand years. At the Leuna works, the coal was converted into heating gases, into benzine and Diesel Oil, into energies, electricities, currents, steams. From the hydrogenation process came huge quantities of Propane and Butane